

WEEKLY BULLETIN

19 February 2018



Traditional house in Gatlang, Rasuwa. These traditional buildings have space on the ground floor for storage of wood and agricultural produce and upstairs is used for the kitchen, sleeping, and storage of clothes and personal items. Photo credit: Magnus Wolfe-Murray/DFID Nepal.





In Gatlang, Rasuwa new one room buildings are being constructed to access the GoN housing reconstruction grant but their traditional houses, mostly reconstructed in 2015, do not currently meet compliance requirements.

Investment is required in research and testing to develop relevant corrections / retrofitting measures so that the traditional houses can be compliant – and most importantly strengthened to reduce risk from future earthquakes.

Photo Credit: Magnus Wolfe-Murray/DFID Nepal.

There are numerous places across the earthquake affected areas where a similar situation is arising with households building one room, one-storey houses so that they can secure the GoN housing reconstruction grant while they continue to live in, or plan to construct, a traditional home that better meets their living requirements. Housing compliance is not just a technical issue and the social requirements of housing need to be given due consideration. Households urgently need socio-technical assistance to better support their planning for reconstruction so that they can maximise their investment in the reconstruction of their homes. The NRA announcement of the extension of the deadline for the second tranche to mid-April is very positive. However, only 27% of households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant having received the second tranche as of 18 February. As a result, the deadline of mid-April may still be an unrealistic goal for 100,000s of households.

Highlights

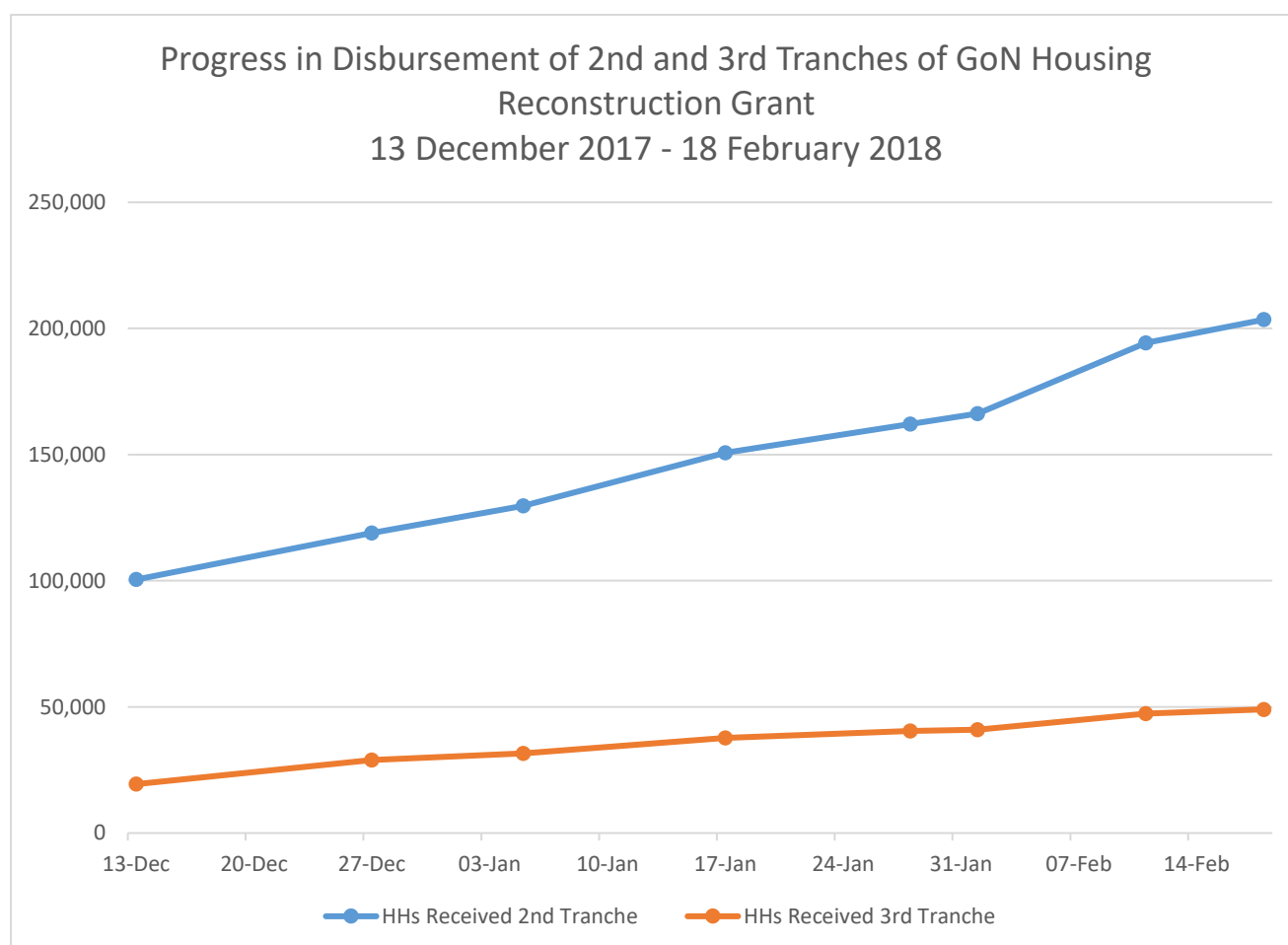
- Please, please, please help improve the platform by taking part in the [HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey](#) – the deadline to submit your responses has been extended to this FRIDAY (23 February)! The HRRP is your platform and your feedback will help to shape it.
- Procedures related to the identification of vulnerable earthquake affected beneficiaries, 2074 ([Nepali, Unofficial English Translation](#))
- MoUD CLPIU M&E Reports, [October-November \(Kartik\)](#) and [November-December \(Mangsir\)](#)
- [Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 870](#): this episode includes stories from Gorkha, Kavre, and Ramechhap, as well as an interview with the NRA CEO.
- Build Change model retrofit in Rasuwa, Gatlang (see districts section)
- Summary of HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 12 February – 19 February
- [The role of scientific evidence during the 2015 Nepal earthquake relief efforts, ODI](#) – please do save the date for an exciting event on 29 March where some of the team behind this report will be presenting on their research in Nepal. More details coming soon!
- [Hidden Aftershocks: An Assessment of the Mental Health and Psychosocial Status and Needs of Earthquake-Affected Communities in Rasuwa, Nuwakot, and Makwanpur Districts, Transcultural Psychosocial Organization Nepal \(TPO Nepal\) and the Red Cross](#)

UPDATES & REQUESTS

National

MoFALD CLPIU Enrolment Data, as of 18 February (Nepali and Unofficial English Translation): the data now includes new columns to provide numbers of households that have applied for the second and third tranche, as well as % columns for all parameters.

	1 February	11 February	18 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	767,705	767,705	767,685
HHs Enrolled	684,468	692,066	689,125
HHs Received 1st Tranche	671,577	679,722	679,859
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche		197,115	229,025
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	166,320	194,297	203,501
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche		47,841	56,367
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	41,003	47,394	49,021



Flood Recovery Planning Meeting, 15 February: the consultant working on preparing the flood recovery plan (Leelaraj Upadhyay, leelaraj.upadhyay@gmail.com, 9851052592) presented the [standard structure for the sector plans](#) and requested partners to send contributions based on their field experience in flood areas to date, as well as experience based on earthquake recovery. Sector plans will be prepared as per the PDNA defined sectors; Social Sector (Housing and Human Settlements, Health and Nutrition, and Education), Productive Sector (Agriculture, Livestock, and Irrigation), and Infrastructure Sector (Transport, Water, Sanitation and Hygiene, and Electricity). Partners were also strongly encouraged to send contributions for the cross-cutting issues section; gender equality

and social inclusion, local employment generation, environmental sustainability, DRR, etc. Partners were also requested to share the completed [simplified 3W form](#) as soon as possible and the [full 3W template](#) by the end of February.

Districts

Gorkha Reconstruction Workshop, Pokhara, 11 and 12 February: the reconstruction workshop was organised by NRA-Gorkha with facilitation support from HRRP Gorkha and the logistics and costs for the event have been shared by development partners (OXFAM, LWF, CARE, WVI, EHRP/JICA, CRS, INF, Build Up, Samaritan's Purse, and GNI) working in the district. The [action plan for recovery in Gorkha during the coming year](#) was finalised during the event and the workshop concluded with the signing of the [Pokhara Declaration 2074](#) ([unofficial English translation](#)). The report from last year's workshop is available [here](#).

Build Change Model Retrofit, Gatlang, Rasuwa: the model retrofitting, carried out under a DFID funded project, involved provision of engineering guidance and masons training from Build Change for the traditional home to be reinforced with RCC columns and ring-beams. It represents just one potential model of retrofitting for such traditional houses, and there are other models that also need to be trialed. The total cost of this retrofitting was approximately 700,000 NPRs (7,000 USD).



The retrofit model in Gatlang, Rasuwa. The timber frontage has been reduced to allow for the new RCC columns and beams to be added. Photo Credit: Magnus Wolfe-Murray/DFID Nepal.



Inside the retrofitted house: the photo on the left shows the new strongbacks on the first floor. These are attached to the stone walls and connected to a timber ringbeam. The photo on the right shows the roundwood posts on the ground floor which are connect with metal straps into concrete raw plugs inserted into the stone wall. Photo Credit: Magnus Wolfe-Murray/DFID Nepal.

'Not so long ago', Kathmandu Valley 1966-1975: a new book of photographs, by Peace Corps volunteer Daniel W. Edwards, provides interesting insight into how must the Kathmandu Valley has changed in the last four decades.

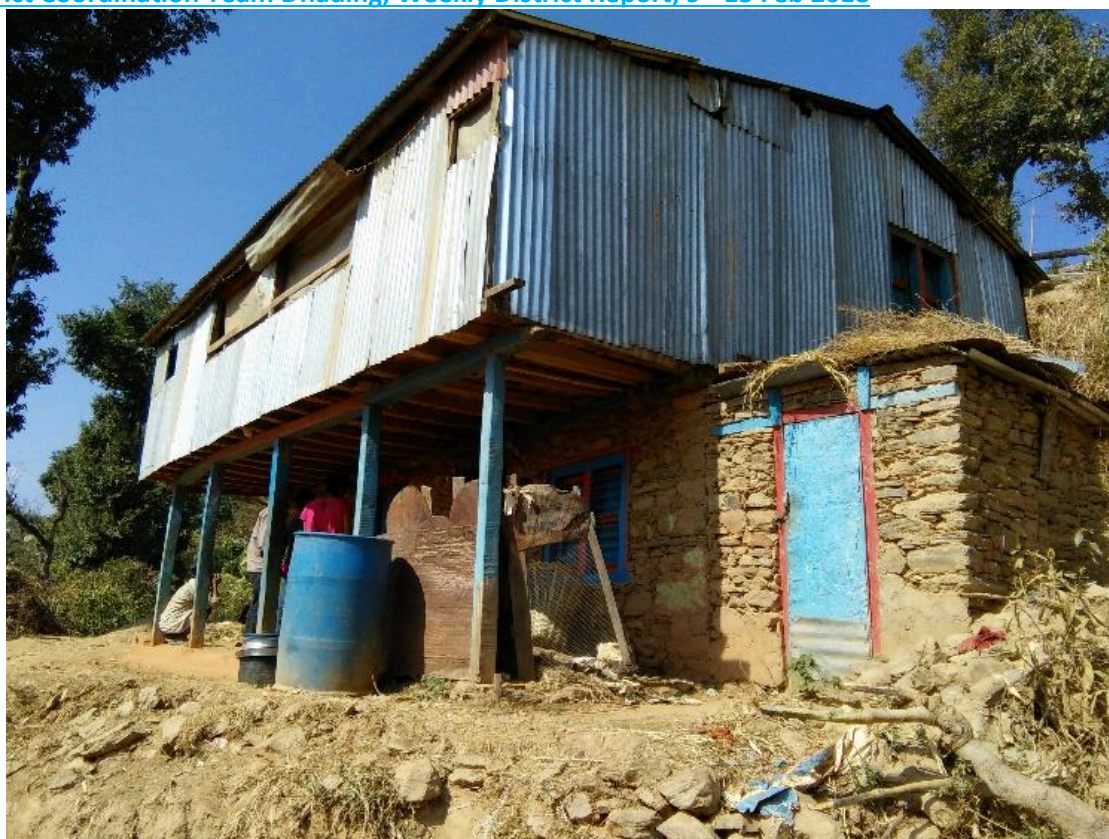


Kathmandu-Bhaktapur Trolley Bus Stop 1975. Photo Credit: Daniel W. Edwards

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 12 February – 19 February: during this period district coordination meetings took place in [Dolakha \(14 February\)](#) and [Lalitpur \(15 February\)](#). Municipal level meetings took place in Likhu RM, Nuwakot (9 February) and Tadi RM, Nuwakot (11 February). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In Dolakha, the process of forwarding the approved inspection forms received from DLPIU-DUDBC by DCC has gained momentum. There are no significant pending files in DCC. More than 50% progress has been made in the approval of second tranche.
- In Lalitpur, the NRA is going to organise an interaction meeting of the 'District Facilitation Committee' on 26 February. The meeting will involve key stakeholders in the district including representatives from municipalities, rural municipalities, and district lines agencies. The purpose of the interaction meeting is to expediate the reconstruction efforts through concerned coordination points.
- In Likhu RM, Nuwakot, the local representatives highlighted the issues related to road access and lack of sufficient water for building houses. Some shared that there are delays in the disbursement of the housing reconstruction tranches by the banks. There 16 households in Likhu RM that are eligible for the reconstruction grant but have not yet completed the partnership agreement with the government. There are also 12 single women headed HHs and another 8 HHs have not received the first tranche of the reconstruction grant.
- In Tadi RM, Nuwakot, local representatives raised concerns about the MoUD DLPIU Engineers working strategy as they are rarely seen in the field visiting households. They also raised concerns regarding the procedures for non-complaint houses to apply correction measures and then receive the tranches.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Weekly District Report, 9 - 15 Feb 2018](#)



Jeevanpur Ward-4, Dhunibesi Rural Municipality, Dhading: two storey, hybrid structure that is non-compliant due to the discontinuity of the horizontal bands and the absence of vertical bands. As a result, the home owner has only received the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 9 - 15 Feb 2018



Mucchok Ward-5, Ajirkot Rural Municipality, Gorkha: brick masonry and cement mortar masonry house, with timber frame and CGI porch. The home owner has received the first and second tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 9 – 15 Feb 2018



Haibung Ward-8, Chisopani Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: this house is a single bay, two storey, RCC structure. It was not approved for the second tranche because the photos were not clear in the inspection files.

Requests for Partner Support

REMINDER, Round 2, HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey: please, please, please help improve the platform by taking part in the survey! The deadline to submit your responses has been extended to this FRIDAY (23 February)! The survey should take approximately 10 to 15 minutes to complete, but will take longer if you choose to provide more detailed feedback in the open answer questions, and can be conducted in Nepali or English. The HRRP is your platform and your feedback will help to shape it.

Researching Barriers and Drivers for Reconstruction, Request to Partners to Share Existing Datasets and Reports: there is an enormous amount of work in this area that has been completed by partners, or is being done regularly. HRRP would like to request partners to make all relevant datasets and reports available to the greatest extent possible. HRRP can support with pulling together data in ways that manages any confidentiality restraints that partners have. Building a strong knowledge base will improve all reconstruction actors' understanding of the reconstruction context and what can be improved. Partners interested to share data / reports may contact Siobhan Kennedy, HRRP Recovery Advisor, siobhan@hrrpnepal.org, with any questions, or may directly upload materials to the HRRP Google Drive [here](#).

Researching Barriers and Drivers for Reconstruction, Field Staff and Local Official Surveys, Request for Feedback: as well as collecting existing datasets and reports, HRRP is planning to conduct surveys with reconstruction field staff as well as local officials in earthquake affected areas with the objective of documenting their experiences in the reconstruction to date and what additional support they feel they require. HRRP would like to request feedback on the draft survey formats which are available [here](#). Feedback and suggestions for improvement can be shared with Rupa Pandey, HRRP MEAL Coordinator, meal@hrrpnepal.org, up to Monday 26 February.

HRRP Temporary Shelter Status Data Collection: to date the majority of support for housing reconstruction has been focused on households that have already started / completed reconstructing their home. This survey aims to collect data from households who are still planning their reconstruction and will look to document what factors have caused them not to start reconstructing yet, as well as the current condition of the shelter. The survey was trialed in Bungmati, Lalitpur on 16 February. The survey format can be downloaded [here](#) (in [Kobo Toolbox](#)) and partners are welcome to share feedback on the questionnaire with Anu Prasai Lama, HRRP National Coordination Officer, nco1@hrrpnepal.org, and are encouraged to support the data collection if possible.

Documenting the Experiences of Women in Reconstruction, HRRP: this survey aims to analyse the involvement of women in the reconstruction process at all levels; women from households eligible for the reconstruction / retrofit grant, women masons working on the reconstruction, women working as part of technical assistance teams at field level, and women working at district or national level in Government or I/NGOs. The survey was trialed in Bungmati, Lalitpur on 16 February. The survey format can be downloaded [here](#) (in [Kobo Toolbox](#)) and partners are welcome to share feedback on the questionnaire with Sushmita Dawadi, HRRP Communications and Content Officer, comms2@hrrpnepal.org, and are encouraged to support the data collection if possible.

HRRP Field Visits to the 17 Moderately Affected Districts: during February and March HRRP will be conducting field visits to the 17 moderately affected districts in order to document the reconstruction status, understand challenges particular to these areas, meet with reconstruction actors and households, and document local housing typologies and common non-compliances. Partners should feel free to contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP National Coordination Officer, minar@hrrpnepal.org, for more information or if they are interested to take part.

DOCUMENTS & PRODUCTS

Government of Nepal

[Procedures related to the identification of vulnerable earthquake affected beneficiaries, 2074 \(Nepali, Unofficial English Translation\)](#)

[Procedures related to the development of integrated settlement, 2074 \(Nepali, Unofficial English Translation\)](#)

[MoUD CLPIU M&E Reports, October-November \(Kartik\) and November-December \(Mangsir\)](#)

[Climate Change Financing Framework, A Road Map to Systematically Strengthen Climate Change Mainstreaming into Planning and Budgeting, Ministry of Finance](#)

HRRP

[Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps](#): based on MoUD CLPIU inspection data as of 5 February.

[Partnership Agreement Signed between HH and GoN](#)

[1st Tranche Received](#)

[Construction Started](#)

[Compliance Rate – 2nd Tranche](#)

[Compliance Rate – 3rd Tranche](#)

[Construction Completed](#)

[Technical Assistance Coverage Maps](#): based on HRRP 4W data as of 25 January 2018.

[Coverage of 7 Technical Assistance Activities](#)

[Areas with no Technical Assistance with Damage Overlay](#)

[Door to Door Technical Assistance](#)

[Community & Household Orientations](#)

[Demonstration House Construction](#)

[Helpdesk / Technical Resources Centre](#)

[Masons Short Training Coverage](#)

[Masons Vocational Training Coverage](#)

Partners

[The role of scientific evidence during the 2015 Nepal earthquake relief efforts, ODI](#): focusing on the 2015 Gorkha earthquakes in Nepal, this report explores the extent to which scientific information was used during the disaster response. The report looks to understand the key actors involved in the response effort, their information needs and how these were communicated to scientists and other knowledge providers, the scientific information that was produced, and how this information was shared. Please do save the date for an exciting event on 29 March where some of the team behind this report will be presenting on their research in Nepal. More details coming soon!

[Hidden Aftershocks: An Assessment of the Mental Health and Psychosocial Status and Needs of Earthquake-Affected Communities in Rasuwa, Nuwakot, and Makwanpur Districts, Transcultural Psychosocial Organization Nepal \(TPO Nepal\) and the Red Cross](#): the American Red Cross commissioned TPO Nepal to conduct a MHPS assessment between November 2016 and January 2017 to assess the prevalence of mental health and psychosocial problems in the earthquake affected population, examine existing MHPS services available in these

communities, and make recommendations on appropriate interventions to address these needs. The assessment is an important contribution to understanding MHPS needs during recovery.

[Sajha Sabha, Kathmandu Living Labs:](#) this is an “open, digital environment to bring citizens, government and local organizations together in one place to discuss and solve issues of public concern”. Local issues can be submitted for review and follow up by SMS, phone, or online. The issues submitted to date can be viewed through the [dashboard](#).

[Milijuli Nepali, BBC Media Action, Episode 870:](#) this episode of Milijuli Nepali includes stories from Gorkha, Kavre, and Ramechhap on communities working together for reconstruction where there is a limited number of masons. The stories also cover the building code requirements for houses and how transporting construction materials in bulk can help to cut construction costs. The programme includes an interview with the NRA's CEO Yubaraj Bhusal on the government decision to extend the deadline for receiving the second tranche of the housing grant to mid-April.

[Baliyo Ghar TV Programme, Episode 91:](#) the programme looks at the progress to date with the reconstruction of Singha Durbar, as well as presenting some of the associated challenges.



[Earthquake Safety Day, National Symposium Short Report:](#) the event, which took place on 7 and 8 January, covered a wide range of issues related to earthquake risk reduction and safer reconstruction and reviewed efforts to date in Nepal on reconstruction, risk reduction, and disaster preparedness. There were 225 participants in the event from a wide range of reconstruction and DRR actors; NRA, MoHA, MoUD, DUDBC, Nepal Army, APF, Nepal Police, NSET, Nepal Red Cross Society, Experts, Academia, Consultancies, Freelancers, Media, and representatives of I/NGOs.

[Access to Justice of Nepalese Migrant Workers: Present-Day Problems and Challenges:](#) joint submission by Law and Policy Forum for Social Justice (LAPSOJ) and Pourakhi Nepal to the UN Special Rapporteur on the Human Rights of Migrants during his recent visit to Nepal.

Mobile Vulnerability Analysis and Mapping (mVAM) Bulletin 2, NeKSAP: based on the results of NeKSAP food security monitoring survey conducted in eight mid- and far-western mountain districts, currently under Province Number 6 and 7 (Humla, Mugu, Jumla, Dolpa, Kalikot, Bajura, Bajhang and Darchula). Survey was conducted based on the panel sample of 694 households in these districts via telephone calls. The panel was established during a face-to-face baseline survey in 2016, in which the phone numbers of households and traders were collected. Two subsequent follow-up rounds of surveys were conducted by telephone interviews.

[Media Digest](#) | [FAQ](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [4W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)